

U.S. HISTORY HACK

Unit 3

American Imperialism & World War I

Empire · The Great War · The Peace · 1890–1920

Standards US.19 – US.27

US.19

US.20

US.21

US.22

US.23

US.24

US.25

US.26

US.27

TCAP EOC LECTURE DECK · Tennessee Academic Standards for U.S. History

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UNIT ROADMAP

Where We Are Headed

Unit 3 • American Imperialism & World War I (1890–1920) — Empire, the Great War & the Peace



BELL RINGER · HOOK

In 1890, the United States had almost no colonies and a small navy.

By 1918, it had an overseas empire and had helped win the largest war in

history.
How did a nation founded in revolt against empire become a world power with colonies and armies fighting in Europe in barely one generation?

TURN & TALK

With a partner, list three reasons a country might want an overseas empire, and three reasons it might get pulled into a war on another continent. Keep your list; we will return to it at the end of the unit.

STANDARD

US.19

Causes of American Imperialism

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including: the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism.

I CAN

I can assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism.

How This Deck Works — UDL 3.0 & MTSS

Teacher reference · CAST UDL 3.0 guidelines designed into every standard

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

ENGAGEMENT

Multiple means of the “why”

- Welcoming Interests & Identities
- Sustaining Effort & Persistence
- Emotional Capacity

REPRESENTATION

Multiple means of the “what”

- Perception
- Language & Symbols
- Building Knowledge

ACTION & EXPRESSION

Multiple means of the “how”

- Interaction
- Expression & Communication
- Strategy Development

MTSS decision cycle: Tier 1 core for all → the Progress Check yields evidence → below mastery routes to targeted reteach (Tier 2, Teacher Guide §16); at/above mastery routes to extension. **The goal never lowers.**

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

Unit 2 What era did we just finish, and what was its central goal?

2

Unit Hook What is the big question of Unit 3?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What is imperialism?

✓ ANSWER

When a strong country takes control of the land, economy, or government of a weaker one.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In 1890 a single book by a naval officer, 'The Influence of Sea Power upon History,' convinced presidents and admirals that America needed colonies and coaling stations across two oceans.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

If the United States was founded by people escaping empire, why would it spend the 1890s building one of its own? What changed?

Economic Motivations for Expansion

- American imperialism was driven significantly by economic factors.
- The growing industrial economy needed raw materials like sugar from Hawaii, rubber, oil, and minerals to fuel production.
- Expanding American manufacturing required overseas consumers for surplus goods, and capitalists sought profitable investment opportunities in underdeveloped regions.
- Strategic naval bases and coaling stations were needed for global commerce and military presence, and fear that European powers would monopolize global markets created urgency for American expansion.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

American imperialism was caused by _____, because the growing economy needed _____ and _____.



Unknown, 1898 [Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Spreading American Democratic and Moral Ideals

- Many Americans believed they had a duty to "civilize" and Christianize peoples they considered "backward"—a concept captured in Rudyard Kipling's poem "White Man's Burden." Social Darwinism applied evolutionary theory to justify American superiority and expansion.
- The ideology of Manifest Destiny, which had driven continental expansion, was extended to overseas territories.
- Missionary activity provided religious motivation, while belief in American exceptionalism held that U.S. political and social institutions were superior and should be exported worldwide.

Yellow Journalism and Public Opinion

- Yellow journalism—sensationalized newspaper reporting that exaggerated stories to sell papers—played a crucial role in building public support for imperialism.
- Key figures William Randolph Hearst (New York Journal) and Joseph Pulitzer (New York World) used dramatic headlines, emotional appeals, and fabricated or exaggerated stories.
- Coverage of alleged Spanish atrocities in Cuba particularly inflamed public opinion, forcing politicians to adopt more aggressive foreign policies.
- This represented the first major example of mass media shaping American foreign policy.

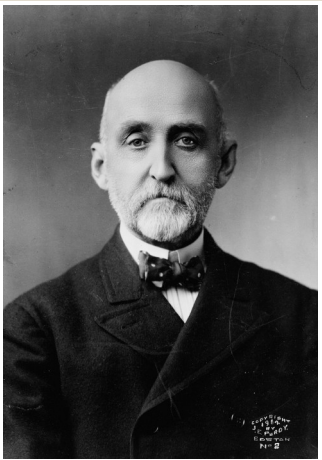


Leon Barritt, 1898 [Library of Congress](#)

Key Figures

Alfred Thayer Mahan

U.S. Navy officer & strategist



Unknown (U.S. Navy), c. 1904 [Library of Congress](#)

- Wrote 'The Influence of Sea Power upon History' (1890)
- Argued national greatness required a powerful navy, overseas bases, and colonies
- Shaped the naval buildup that drove U.S. imperialism

STRATEGY Anchor the 'why now?' of imperialism in Mahan's sea-power thesis before students see the map of acquisitions.

Queen Liliuokalani

Last monarch of the Hawaiian Kingdom



Prince, Washington, D.C. (photographer), c. 1891 [Library of Congress](#)

- Sought to restore native Hawaiian voting power with a new constitution
- Was overthrown in 1893 by U.S.-backed planters and Marines
- Formally protested annexation in 1897

STRATEGY Use her protest to give students the perspective of the annexed, not just the annexers.

Queen Liliuokalani's Protest to the Annexation of Hawaii

Queen Liliuokalani • June 17, 1897

Close Reading

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Prince, Washington, D.C. (photographer), c. 1891 [Library of Congress](#)

"I, Liliuokalani, by the Grace of God and under the Constitution of the Hawaiian Kingdom, Queen, do hereby solemnly protest against any and all acts done against myself and the constitutional Government of the Hawaiian Kingdom... Because the official protests made by me on the seventeenth day of January, 1893, to the so-called Provisional Government was not combatted with armed forces, and because said Provisional Government has been combatted with armed forces, I yield my authority until such time as the Government of the United States shall... undo the action of its representatives

CONTEXT

In January 1893, a group of American sugar planters and businessmen — with support from U.S. Marines who landed from the USS Boston — overthrew Queen Liliuokalani and ended the Hawaiian monarchy. The Queen yielded only to avoid bloodshed, believing the U.S. government would restore her. President Grover Cleveland investigated and found the overthrow illegal, but Congress refused to act. When the McKinley administration came to power, it pushed for annexation as part of America's growing Pacific empire. Queen Liliuokalani's protest to Congress in 1897 was one of the last formal challenges to a takeover the United States refused to undo.

ANALYZE

What does Queen Liliuokalani's protest reveal about the annexation of Hawaii?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Queen Liliuokalani	June 17, 1897	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Imperialism

say: im-PEER-ee-uh-liz-um

Imperialismo

I

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Alfred Thayer Mahan

say: AL-fred THAY-er muh-HAN

Alfred Thayer Mahan

AT

U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.

Roosevelt Corollary

say: ROH-zuh-velt KOR-uh-lair-ee

Corolario Roosevelt

RC

Theodore Roosevelt's 1904 addition to the Monroe Doctrine, asserting the U.S. right to intervene in Latin American countries to maintain stability and prevent European intervention.

Yellow Journalism

Periodismo Amarillo

YJ

Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Spanish-American War

Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense

SW

A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.

Theodore Roosevelt

Theodore Roosevelt

TR

The 26th U.S. President (1901-1909) known for progressive reforms, trust-busting, conservation, and aggressive foreign policy including building the Panama Canal and expanding American influence.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Identify cause and effect

MODEL PROMPT: Which economic need most directly pushed the U.S. toward overseas empire?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

I see three economic drivers named: raw materials, new markets, and naval bases. The text says fear of European monopoly created 'urgency,' so I rank markets and materials highest.

THINK ALOUD

Underline every economic word in the section, then rank the top two.

→ **Now you try:** *With a partner, decide whether economic or moral motives were stronger, and cite one line as proof.*

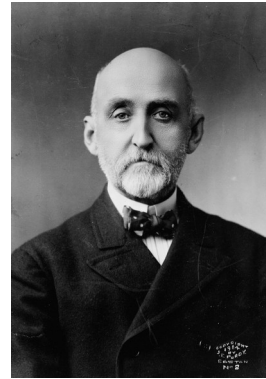
Causes of American Imperialism - Motive Sorter

Pairs

12 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and Queen Liliuokalani's protest, sort the causes of American imperialism into three columns: Economic, Strategic/Military, and Moral/Cultural. Place at least two causes in each column. Then write a one-sentence claim naming which category was the strongest driver and cite one piece of evidence from Direct Instruction or the primary source.



Unknown (U.S. Navy), c. 1904 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-column sorter (2+ causes per column) AND a one-sentence, evidence-based claim about the strongest driver.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Sorter with a word bank of causes provided; students place each cause in the correct column (no written claim required). Honors: Write a paragraph arguing whether 'spreading democracy' was a genuine motive or a justification for economic self-interest, using two pieces of evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us19-causes-of-imperialism.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What does Queen Liliuokalani's protest reveal about the annexation of Hawaii?

- A** She willingly surrendered power to the United States
- B** She protested the overthrow as illegal and yielded only to avoid bloodshed, hoping the U.S. would restore her
- C** She supported American annexation of Hawaii
- D** She requested military assistance from Japan

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What does Queen Liliuokalani's protest reveal about the annexation of Hawaii?

- A** She willingly surrendered power to the United States
- B** She protested the overthrow as illegal and yielded only to avoid bloodshed, hoping the U.S. would restore her ✓
- C** She supported American annexation of Hawaii
- D** She requested military assistance from Japan

Correct answer: B. Why: Liliuokalani's protest shows she considered the overthrow illegitimate and yielded authority only temporarily, expecting the U.S. to "undo the action" and "reinstate" her.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Economic Motivations for Expansion
- Spreading American Democratic and Moral Ideals
- Yellow Journalism and Public Opinion

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: To what extent was 'spreading democracy' a genuine motive versus a cover for economic self-interest?
Using at least two pieces of evidence, argue your position. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how economic motives and moral or cultural motives BOTH pushed the United States toward imperialism. Which do you think was the stronger force, and why?

STANDARD

US.20

Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.01

Collect sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period.

I CAN

I can compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period.

Words you need before we read

Imperialism

En español: *Imperialismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Yellow Journalism

En español: *Periodismo Amarillo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Alfred Thayer Mahan

En español: *Alfred Thayer Mahan*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.

Check your understanding

Analyze how economic, moral, and media factors combined to create support for American expansion overseas.

A Economic interests created motivation, moral justifications provided legitimacy, and yellow journalism built popular support—together creating an irresistible push for imperialism

✓ KEY

B Only one factor mattered; the others were irrelevant, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture

C These factors worked against each other, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise

D Public opinion was never important for imperial policy, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.19 Name two economic causes of American imperialism.

2

US.19 What was yellow journalism, and how did it push the country toward expansion?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What did anti-imperialists (non-interventionists) believe the U.S. should NOT do?

✓ **ANSWER**

Take over and rule other peoples, because governing without consent betrayed American democratic ideals.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

When the Senate debated keeping the Philippines in 1899, Senator Beveridge called it America's God-given destiny, while Mark Twain called it a betrayal of everything the flag stood for.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Can a nation 'free' a people and 'rule' them at the same time? Which side of that debate would you have taken?

Interventionist Arguments

- Interventionists argued that overseas markets were essential for American prosperity and preventing economic depression.
- They believed America needed naval bases and strategic positions to protect its interests, and had a moral duty to spread democracy, Christianity, and civilization.
- Key figures like Theodore Roosevelt, Henry Cabot Lodge, and Alfred Thayer Mahan argued that the U.S. must compete with European powers for global influence or be left behind.
- They also pointed to humanitarian reasons to help oppressed peoples gain freedom from tyrannical rulers.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Interventionists believed the U.S. should _____, while anti-interventionists argued that _____.



Victor Gillam, 1899 [Wikimedia Commons](#) ([Judge magazine](#))

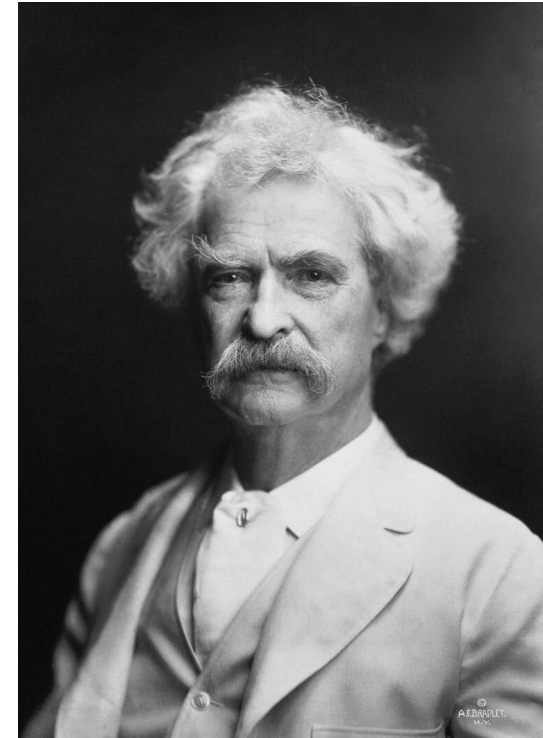
TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Non-Interventionist Arguments

- Non-interventionists, including William Jennings Bryan, Andrew Carnegie, and Mark Twain, raised constitutional concerns that imperialism violated American principles of self-government and consent of the governed.
- They worried about the economic costs of military adventures and argued it was morally wrong to impose American rule on unwilling peoples.
- Some had racial concerns about incorporating non-white populations, while others emphasized the anti-militarism tradition and Washington's warning against foreign entanglements.
- The American Anti-Imperialist League organized formal opposition.

Comparing Political, Economic, and Moral Factors

- Politically, interventionists believed American power should be projected globally with strong executive authority, while non-interventionists favored limited government and congressional control.
- Economically, interventionists emphasized overseas markets and resources, while opponents worried about the costs of military commitments.
- Morally, interventionists stressed the civilizing mission and humanitarian intervention, while non-interventionists emphasized self-determination and constitutional principles.
- Regional differences also emerged, with the Northeast and West more interventionist, the South and Midwest more isolationist.



A. F. Bradley, New York, 1907 [Library of Congress](#)

Key Figures

Albert J. Beveridge

U.S. Senator (Indiana), expansionist



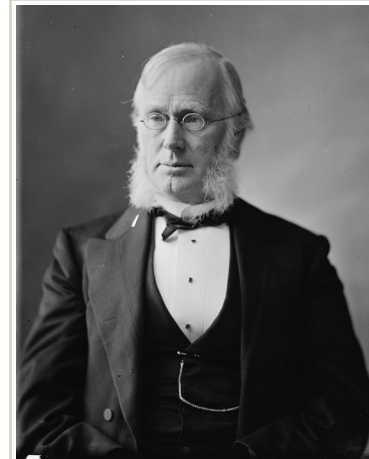
Unknown, c. 1900 [Library of Congress](#)

- Delivered 'The March of the Flag' (1898)
- Argued expansion was America's God-given destiny and duty
- Voice of the interventionist camp

STRATEGY Pair Beveridge and Hoar back-to-back so students hear both sides of the great debate in the speakers' own words.

George Frisbie Hoar

U.S. Senator (Massachusetts), anti-imperialist



Brady-Handy Photograph Collection, c. 1890s [Library of Congress](#)

- Led Senate opposition to annexing the Philippines
- Argued empire betrayed the Declaration of Independence
- Founding voice of the Anti-Imperialist League cause

STRATEGY Have students label each senator's core argument (economic, moral, political) as they read.

Speech Against Philippine Annexation

Argumentation

Senator George Frisbie Hoar • January 9, 1899

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Brady-Handy Photograph Collection, c. 1890s [Library of Congress](#)

"You have no right at the cannon's mouth to impose on an unwilling people your Declaration of Independence and your Constitution and your notions of freedom and notions of what is good... If you undertake to govern without their consent, you may count upon resistance. The Malays are not fools. The inhabitants of the Philippine Islands are intelligent and warlike people."

CONTEXT

Senator George Frisbie Hoar of Massachusetts was one of the most prominent voices in the American Anti-Imperialist League, which opposed U.S. annexation of the Philippines after the Spanish-American War. Anti-imperialists argued that colonizing the Philippines violated the Declaration of Independence, the Constitution, and American ideals of self-determination. They included figures as different as Andrew Carnegie, Mark Twain, Jane Addams, and former President Grover Cleveland. Hoar's January 1899 Senate speech against annexation was one of the most powerful congressional arguments against empire, but the Senate narrowly approved the Treaty of Paris (with the Philippines) by a vote of 57-27.

ANALYZE

What constitutional argument did Senator Hoar make against Philippine annexation?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Senator George Frisbie Hoar	January 9, 1899	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [U.S. Senate Historical Office](#)

Word Wall

Imperialism

say: im-PEER-ee-uh-liz-um

Imperialismo

I

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Alfred Thayer Mahan

say: AL-fred THAY-er muh-HAN

Alfred Thayer Mahan

AT

U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.

Roosevelt Corollary

say: ROH-zuh-velt KOR-uh-lair-ee

Corolario Roosevelt

RC

Theodore Roosevelt's 1904 addition to the Monroe Doctrine, asserting the U.S. right to intervene in Latin American countries to maintain stability and prevent European intervention.

Yellow Journalism

Periodismo Amarillo

YJ

Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Spanish-American War

Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense

SW

A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.

Emilio Aguinaldo

say: eh-MEE-lee-oh ah-gee-NAHL-doh

Emilio Aguinaldo

EA

Filipino independence leader who initially fought alongside Americans against Spain, then led the Philippine resistance against U.S. occupation (1899-1901).

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Compare competing arguments

MODEL PROMPT: How does Beveridge justify expansion, and how does Hoar answer him?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Beveridge uses destiny and duty ('the march of the flag'). Hoar answers with the Declaration: you cannot govern people without their consent.

THINK ALOUD

Label each senator's core appeal: economic, moral, or political.

→ **Now you try:** Write one sentence stating which argument is stronger and why, using a quote.

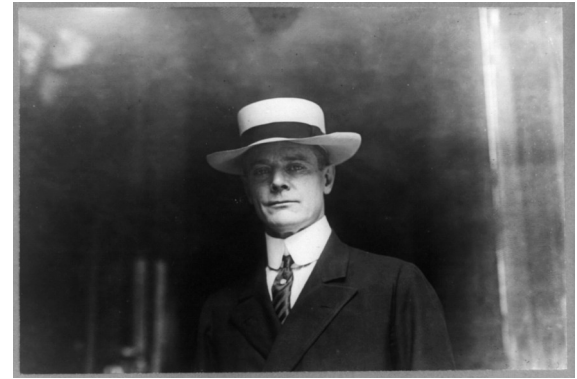
The Great Debate - Interventionist vs. Anti-Interventionist

Pairs, then whole-class share

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the excerpts from Beveridge ('The March of the Flag') and Hoar (anti-annexation). For each speaker, identify (1) his main claim, (2) his strongest piece of evidence, and (3) whether his appeal is economic, moral, or political. Then decide which argument is more consistent with the Declaration of Independence and defend your choice in two sentences.



Unknown, c. 1900 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-column analysis for both senators AND a two-sentence position identifying the stronger argument with evidence.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Sentence frames provided ('Beveridge argues ____ because _____. Hoar argues ____ because _____.') and a checklist of appeal types. Honors: Write a short paragraph connecting this 1899 debate to a modern debate over U.S. involvement abroad, citing one historical and one present-day example.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us20-great-debate.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What constitutional argument did Senator Hoar make against Philippine annexation?

- A** The Philippines were too valuable to annex
- B** Governing people without their consent contradicts American principles of freedom
- C** The U.S. military was too weak to hold the islands
- D** Only European nations should have colonies

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What constitutional argument did Senator Hoar make against Philippine annexation?

- A** The Philippines were too valuable to annex
- B** Governing people without their consent contradicts American principles of freedom ✓
- C** The U.S. military was too weak to hold the islands
- D** Only European nations should have colonies

Correct answer: B. Why: Hoar argued that imposing American rule "at the cannon's mouth" on "an unwilling people" contradicted the very Declaration of Independence America claimed to spread.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Interventionist Arguments
- Non-Interventionist Arguments
- Comparing Political, Economic, and Moral Factors

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Were the anti-imperialists motivated more by principle or by other concerns such as racism or economic interest? Defend your claim with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Summarize the strongest interventionist argument and the strongest anti-interventionist argument. Which was more consistent with American founding principles?

STANDARD

US.21

Spanish-American War & Imperialism Outcomes

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including: Annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, Access to Cuba.

I CAN

I can describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including the annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, and access to Cuba.

Words you need before we read

Imperialism

En español: *Imperialismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Yellow Journalism

En español: *Periodismo Amarillo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Alfred Thayer Mahan

En español: *Alfred Thayer Mahan*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.

Check your understanding

Compare the political, economic, and moral factors that divided interventionists and non-interventionists.

- A Both sides agreed on all major points, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- B Interventionists emphasized global power projection, economic opportunity, and civilizing mission while non-interventionists stressed limited government, costs, and self-determination** ✓ KEY
- C Only economic factors created disagreement, but this fails to account for the broader historical context despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- D Moral arguments were identical on both sides, although historical sources do not support this conclusion when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.20 What was the core argument of the anti-imperialists?

2

US.19 Who was Alfred Thayer Mahan and why did he matter?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Which 1898 war made the United States an overseas empire?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Spanish-American War, after which the U.S. gained Puerto Rico, Guam, the Philippines, and control of Cuba.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In just four months in 1898, the United States defeated Spain and took control of Puerto Rico, Guam, the Philippines, and Cuba, becoming an overseas empire almost overnight.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How could a war that lasted a single summer change America's role in the world for the next century?

Causes of the Spanish-American War

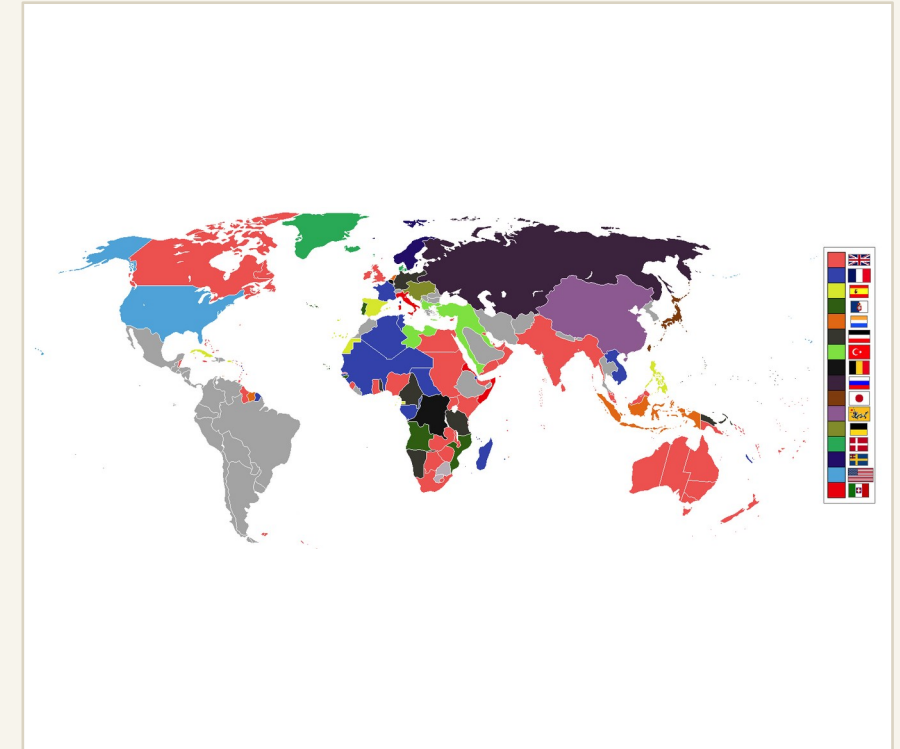
- The Cuban rebellion against Spanish rule (1895) created a humanitarian crisis and threatened American sugar investments.
- The USS Maine explosion in Havana Harbor (February 15, 1898) killed 266 Americans, with yellow journalism blaming Spain despite unclear evidence.
- The de Lôme Letter, in which the Spanish ambassador insulted President McKinley, further inflamed opinion.
- Reports of Spanish atrocities in Cuban concentration camps combined with "Remember the Maine!" headlines to push America toward war.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Spanish-American War made the United States _____, because it gained _____ and _____.

Territorial Outcomes of American Imperialism

- Hawaii was annexed in 1898 after American sugar planters had dominated its economy and overthrown Queen Liliuokalani (1893), providing Pearl Harbor as a strategic naval base.
- The Treaty of Paris gave the U.S. Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines.
- The Philippine Insurrection (1899-1902) followed when Filipinos under Emilio Aguinaldo fought for independence they expected after Spain's defeat, resulting in 200,000+ Filipino deaths before American victory.
- The Panama Canal (1904-1914) was secured after the U.S. supported Panamanian independence from Colombia.



Cartographer (public-domain map), 1898 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Cuba and the Roosevelt Corollary

- The Teller Amendment had promised Cuban independence, but the Platt Amendment (1901) restricted Cuban sovereignty and allowed U.S. intervention, establishing Guantanamo Bay as a permanent naval base.
- American companies came to control Cuban sugar.
- The Roosevelt Corollary (1904) extended the Monroe Doctrine, declaring the U.S. would act as "international police power" to prevent European intervention in Latin America.
- This was used to justify interventions in the Dominican Republic, Nicaragua, and Haiti, establishing American hegemony in the Western Hemisphere.

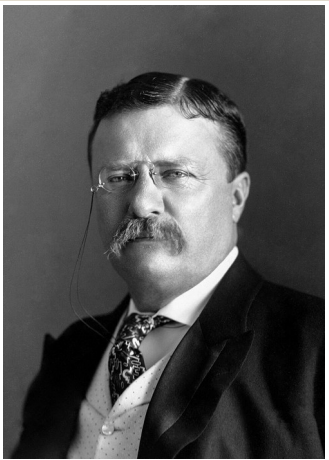
★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee volunteers served in the Spanish-American War, and returning veterans fed the state's growing role in national military affairs, a role that would deepen in World War I.

Key Figures

Theodore Roosevelt

Rough Rider, later 26th President



Pach Brothers, 1904 [Library of Congress](#)

- Led the Rough Riders at San Juan Heights (1898)
- Issued the Roosevelt Corollary (1904)
- Championed the Panama Canal

STRATEGY Trace Roosevelt from war hero to president to show how the war produced a new kind of leader.

Emilio Aguinaldo

Filipino independence leader



Unknown, c. 1898 [Library of Congress](#)

- Allied with the U.S. against Spain in 1898
- Declared Philippine independence
- Led the Philippine-American War against U.S. rule (1899-1902)

STRATEGY Use Aguinaldo to complicate the 'liberation' narrative: the U.S. freed the Philippines from Spain, then fought to keep it.

Treaty of Paris

United States and Spain • December 10, 1898

Close Reading



Unknown, 1898 [Library of Congress](#)

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.

"Spain cedes to the United States the archipelago known as the Philippine Islands... Spain cedes to the United States the island of Porto Rico and other islands now under Spanish sovereignty in the West Indies, and the island of Guam in the Marianas... The United States will pay to Spain the sum of twenty million dollars within three months after the exchange of the ratifications of the present treaty."

CONTEXT

The Treaty of Paris (December 10, 1898) ended the Spanish-American War and marked a turning point in American history. Spain ceded Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines to the United States — the last for \$20 million. Cuba became nominally independent but under heavy American influence. The treaty transformed the United States into an overseas colonial empire with territories across the Caribbean and the Pacific. The Senate ratification debate was fierce — the treaty passed by only two votes above the two-thirds threshold required. Anti-imperialists like Mark Twain and Andrew Carnegie bitterly opposed it, while expansionists like Beveridge and Roosevelt celebrated it as America's destiny.

ANALYZE

What territories did the United States acquire through the Treaty of Paris?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	United States and Spain	December 10, 1898	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Avalon Project, Yale Law School](#)

Word Wall

Spanish-American War

Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense

SW

A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.

Panama Canal

Canal de Panamá

PC

A man-made waterway connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, built by the United States (1904-1914) after supporting Panama's independence from Colombia.

Theodore Roosevelt

Theodore Roosevelt

TR

The 26th U.S. President (1901-1909) known for progressive reforms, trust-busting, conservation, and aggressive foreign policy including building the Panama Canal and expanding American influence.

Philippine Insurrection

Insurrección Filipina

say: FILL-uh-peen in-suh-REK-shun

PI

A guerrilla war (1899-1902) fought by Filipino independence fighters against U.S. forces after the Spanish-American War, when Filipinos realized America intended to rule rather than liberate them.

Roosevelt Corollary

Corolario Roosevelt

say: ROH-zuh-velt KOR-uh-lair-ee

RC

Theodore Roosevelt's 1904 addition to the Monroe Doctrine, asserting the U.S. right to intervene in Latin American countries to maintain stability and prevent European intervention.

Emilio Aguinaldo

Emilio Aguinaldo

say: eh-MEE-lee-oh ah-gee-NAHL-doh

EA

Filipino independence leader who initially fought alongside Americans against Spain, then led the Philippine resistance against U.S. occupation (1899-1901).

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Sequence and connect events

MODEL PROMPT: How did one short war reshape America's role in the world?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

In four months the U.S. gained Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines, and control over Cuba. That turned a continental nation into an overseas empire.

THINK ALOUD

Order the territorial outcomes on a timeline.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain to a partner how the Roosevelt Corollary grew out of these gains.*

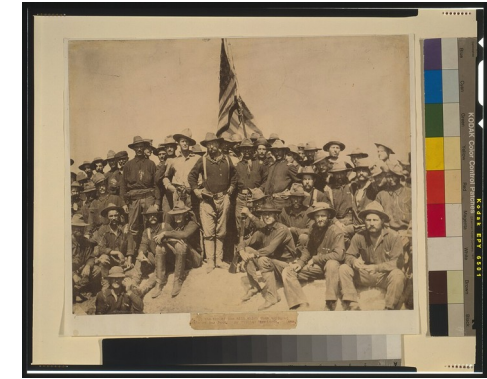
Four Months, Four Conquests - Cause-and-Effect Timeline

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using the map of 1898 acquisitions and your notes, build a timeline of the Spanish-American War and its outcomes: causes (including the USS Maine and yellow journalism), the war itself, and the territorial results (Puerto Rico, Guam, Philippines, Cuba). Then explain in two sentences how these gains led directly to the Roosevelt Corollary.



William Dinwiddie, 1898 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed timeline with at least five ordered events AND a two-sentence explanation linking the war's outcomes to the Roosevelt Corollary.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Timeline with event cards to sequence and a word bank of the four territories. Honors: Add a paragraph evaluating whether the U.S. acted as a liberator or a colonial power, using the Philippines and Cuba as evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us21-spanish-american-war.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did the Platt Amendment limit Cuban sovereignty despite the Teller Amendment's promise?

- A** It gave Cuba complete independence with no restrictions
- B** It required Cuba to allow U.S. intervention and provide naval base land
- C** It made Cuba a full U.S. state
- D** It returned Cuba to Spanish control

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the Platt Amendment limit Cuban sovereignty despite the Teller Amendment's promise?

- A** It gave Cuba complete independence with no restrictions
- B** It required Cuba to allow U.S. intervention and provide naval base land ✓
- C** It made Cuba a full U.S. state
- D** It returned Cuba to Spanish control

Correct answer: B. Why: The Platt Amendment gave the U.S. "the right to intervene" and required Cuba to "sell or lease... lands necessary for coaling or naval stations," limiting Cuban independence.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Causes of the Spanish-American War
- Territorial Outcomes of American Imperialism
- Cuba and the Roosevelt Corollary

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was the United States a 'liberator' or a new colonial power in 1898? Use the Philippines and Cuba as evidence to argue your position. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how the Spanish-American War transformed the United States, using at least two specific territorial or political outcomes.

STANDARD

US.22

Diplomatic Policies: Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral Diplomacy

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy.

I CAN

I can compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Wilson's Moral Diplomacy.

Words you need before we read

Spanish-American War

En español: *Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.

Philippine Insurrection

En español: *Insurrección Filipina*

WHAT IT MEANS

A guerrilla war (1899-1902) fought by Filipino independence fighters against U.S. forces after the Spanish-American War, when Filipinos realized America intended to rule rather than liberate them.

Panama Canal

En español: *Canal de Panamá*

WHAT IT MEANS

A man-made waterway connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, built by the United States (1904-1914) after supporting Panama's independence from Colombia.

Check your understanding

Analyze whether the benefits of American imperialism outweighed the costs and controversies it created.

- A** Benefits clearly outweighed all costs, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B** There were no benefits to American imperialism, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C** **America gained strategic bases, markets, and global influence, but faced costly conflicts like the Philippine Insurrection, contradicted democratic ideals, and created lasting resentment—a complex legacy with both gains and significant moral and practical costs** ✓ KEY
- D** Imperialism had no lasting consequences, which does not align with the documented historical record, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.21 What four territories or areas did the U.S. gain control of after the Spanish-American War?

2

US.21 What was the Roosevelt Corollary?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Which president is linked to 'Big Stick' diplomacy?

✓ **ANSWER**

Theodore Roosevelt: 'speak softly and carry a big stick,' backing negotiation with military strength.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Three presidents in a row, Roosevelt, Taft, and Wilson, each claimed to protect American interests abroad, but one used warships, one used bankers, and one used moral judgment.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

If you wanted to expand your country's influence, would you reach for the military, the checkbook, or your principles? Why?

Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick Diplomacy (1901-1909)

- "Speak softly and carry a big stick" meant using diplomacy backed by military force.
- Roosevelt believed America should be respected and feared as a world power.
- Key strategies included building a powerful navy, using threat of force to achieve objectives, and acting as mediator when it served American interests.
- Applications included the Great White Fleet naval demonstration (1907-1909), mediating the Russo-Japanese War (winning Roosevelt the Nobel Peace Prize), the Roosevelt Corollary, and supporting Panamanian independence to secure canal rights.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Roosevelt used _____, Taft used _____, and Wilson used _____ to expand American influence.



William Allen Rogers, 1904 [Wikimedia Commons \(New York Herald\)](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy (1909-1913)

- Taft believed economic influence was more effective and less costly than military force.
- His strategy encouraged American investment in foreign countries, used financial leverage to influence governments, and sought to replace European influence with American economic control.
- Applications included attempting to secure American participation in Chinese railway development and encouraging American banks to refinance foreign debts in Latin America.
- Results were mixed—Dollar Diplomacy often required military intervention anyway and was less successful than Roosevelt's approach.



Underwood & Underwood, c. 1907 [Library of Congress](#)

Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy (1913-1921)

- Wilson believed foreign policy should reflect American moral values and democratic ideals.
- His philosophy was to support only legitimate, democratic governments, oppose tyranny, and use moral persuasion rather than force when possible.
- Applications included refusing to recognize Mexico's Huerta government, entering World War I to "make the world safe for democracy," promoting self-determination through the Fourteen Points, and attempting to create the League of Nations.
- Wilson's approach produced mixed results and sometimes contradicted itself with military interventions.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee's own Cordell Hull, then a young congressman, was shaping the low-tariff, pro-trade philosophy that would later guide U.S. diplomacy and win him a Nobel Peace Prize as Secretary of State.

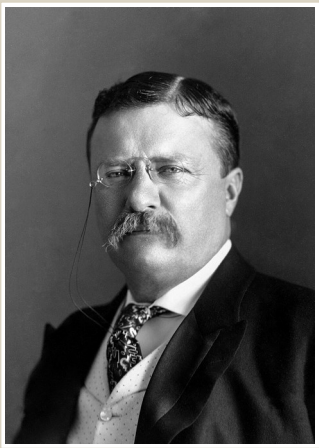
Comparing the Three Approaches

- All three sought to expand American influence and believed America had a special world role.
- All were willing to intervene in Latin America.
- However, their methods differed: Roosevelt used military threat, Taft used economic leverage, Wilson used moral persuasion.
- Roosevelt emphasized power, Taft emphasized profit, Wilson emphasized principles.
- Roosevelt was most successful in achieving immediate goals, Taft least successful, and Wilson produced mixed results.
- Each approach had strengths and weaknesses that shaped American foreign policy.

Key Figures

Theodore Roosevelt

26th President (Big Stick)



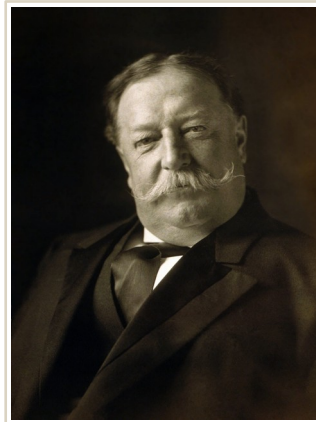
Pach Brothers, 1904 [Library of Congress](#)

- 'Speak softly and carry a big stick'
- Built the Panama Canal
- Mediated the Russo-Japanese War (Nobel Peace Prize)

STRATEGY Use the political cartoon to have students decode the 'big stick' metaphor before defining the policy.

William Howard Taft

27th President (Dollar Diplomacy)



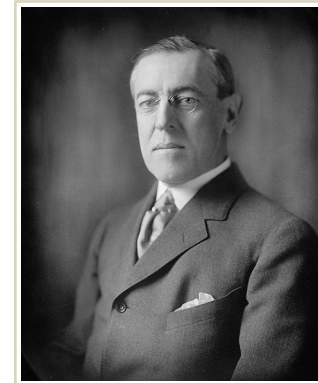
Unknown, c. 1909 [Library of Congress](#)

- Substituted 'dollars for bullets' in foreign policy
- Promoted U.S. banking and business abroad
- Later served as Chief Justice

STRATEGY Set up a three-column organizer (Roosevelt/Taft/Wilson) that students fill in across the section.

Woodrow Wilson

28th President (Moral Diplomacy)



Harris & Ewing, 1913 [Library of Congress](#)

- Judged foreign governments by their morality
- Refused to recognize regimes seen as unjust
- Intervened in Mexico and the Caribbean

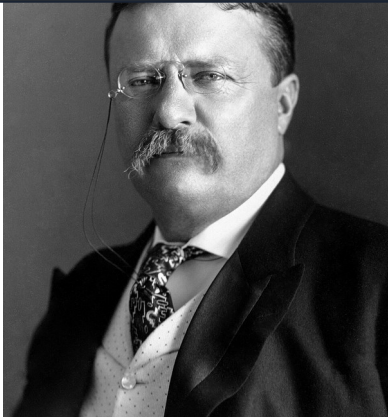
STRATEGY Close by asking which diplomacy students would choose and why - evidence required.

Big Stick Diplomacy Speech

Close Reading

President Theodore Roosevelt • 1901

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Pach Brothers, 1904 [Library of Congress](#)

"There is a homely adage which runs 'Speak softly and carry a big stick; you will go far.' If the American nation will speak softly and yet build and keep at a pitch of the highest training a thoroughly efficient navy, the Monroe Doctrine will go far... Right here let me make as strong a plea as I know how in favor of the Navy."

CONTEXT

Theodore Roosevelt came to the presidency after McKinley's assassination in September 1901. His famous 'speak softly and carry a big stick' foreign policy philosophy — derived from a West African proverb — reflected his belief that American interests in the Caribbean and Latin America had to be backed by military force and the willingness to use it. As president, Roosevelt ordered military interventions in Panama, the Dominican Republic, and Cuba, and used the threat of force to ensure that European powers stayed out of the Western Hemisphere. His 'big stick' approach shaped American foreign policy in the region for decades and is still debated today.

ANALYZE

What was the key principle of Roosevelt's Big Stick Diplomacy?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Theodore Roosevelt	1901	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Big Stick Diplomacy

Diplomacia del Gran Garrote

BS

Theodore Roosevelt's foreign policy approach summarized as "speak softly and carry a big stick," combining negotiation with the implicit threat of military force.

Moral Diplomacy

Diplomacia Moral

MD

Woodrow Wilson's foreign policy rejecting imperialism and emphasizing support for democratic governments and self-determination, though often inconsistently applied.

William Howard Taft

William Howard Taft

WH

The 27th U.S. President (1909-1913) who promoted Dollar Diplomacy, using American economic power to extend influence in Latin America and Asia.

Dollar Diplomacy

Diplomacia del Dólar

DD

President William Howard Taft's foreign policy emphasizing American business investment and loans to extend influence abroad, especially in Latin America and East Asia.

Theodore Roosevelt

Theodore Roosevelt

TR

The 26th U.S. President (1901-1909) known for progressive reforms, trust-busting, conservation, and aggressive foreign policy including building the Panama Canal and expanding American influence.

Woodrow Wilson

Woodrow Wilson

WW

The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Categorize and compare

MODEL PROMPT: How were Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral diplomacy different tools for the same goal?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

All three expanded U.S. influence, but Roosevelt used force, Taft used money, and Wilson used moral judgment.

THINK ALOUD

Fill in the three-column organizer with one example each.

→ **Now you try:** *Pick the approach you find most effective and defend it with evidence.*

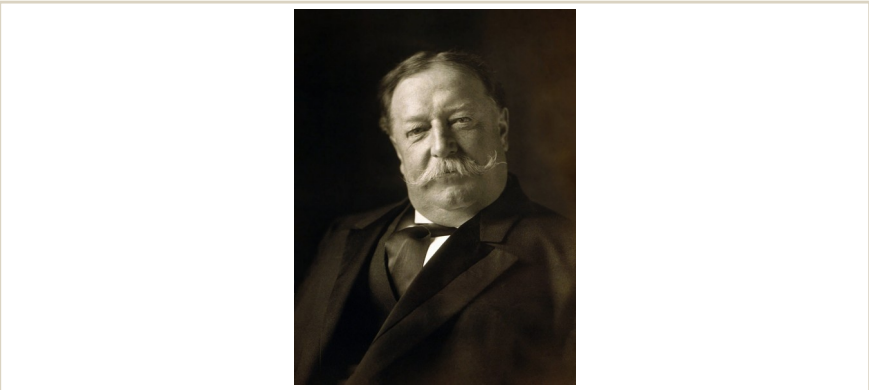
Three Presidents, Three Policies - Diplomacy Comparison Chart

Pairs

12 min

YOUR TASK

Complete a three-column chart comparing Big Stick (Roosevelt), Dollar (Taft), and Moral (Wilson) diplomacy. For each, record: the main tool used, one real example, and one strength or weakness. Then write a one-sentence claim ranking which approach best served long-term U.S. interests, with evidence.



Unknown, c. 1909 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-column chart (tool, example, strength/weakness for each president) AND a one-sentence ranked claim with evidence.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart pre-labeled with the three tools; students match examples from a word bank.
Honors: Write a paragraph defending your ranking and predicting how each approach might apply to a modern foreign-policy challenge.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us22-diplomacy-comparison.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did Taft describe his Dollar Diplomacy approach?

- A** Substituting economic investment for military intervention
- B** Using military force to open foreign markets
- C** Isolating America from all foreign involvement
- D** Spreading democracy through moral persuasion

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Taft describe his Dollar Diplomacy approach?

- A** Substituting economic investment for military intervention ✓
- B** Using military force to open foreign markets
- C** Isolating America from all foreign involvement
- D** Spreading democracy through moral persuasion

Correct answer: A. Why: Taft describes his policy as "substituting dollars for bullets," meaning using economic means rather than military force.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick Diplomacy (1901-1909)
- William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy (1909-1913)
- Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy (1913-1921)
- Comparing the Three Approaches

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Which of the three diplomatic approaches best served long-term U.S. interests? Rank them and justify your ranking with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Compare Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral diplomacy. How were they different tools aimed at the same goal of expanding U.S. influence?

STANDARD

US.23

Causes of World War I & U.S. Neutrality

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

I CAN

I can explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

Words you need before we read

■ Big Stick Diplomacy

En español: *Diplomacia del Gran Garrote*

WHAT IT MEANS

Theodore Roosevelt's foreign policy approach summarized as "speak softly and carry a big stick," combining negotiation with the implicit threat of military force.

■ Dollar Diplomacy

En español: *Diplomacia del Dólar*

WHAT IT MEANS

President William Howard Taft's foreign policy emphasizing American business investment and loans to extend influence abroad, especially in Latin America and East Asia.

■ Moral Diplomacy

En español: *Diplomacia Moral*

WHAT IT MEANS

Woodrow Wilson's foreign policy rejecting imperialism and emphasizing support for democratic governments and self-determination, though often inconsistently applied.

Check your understanding

Evaluate the effectiveness of these three diplomatic approaches in advancing American interests.

- A All three approaches were equally effective, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B None of the approaches achieved any goals, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- C Only economic approaches were effective, which does not align with the documented historical record and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D Big Stick Diplomacy achieved clear results through credible force, Dollar Diplomacy struggled without military backup, and Moral Diplomacy inspired but sometimes proved unrealistic—each revealed different tools of statecraft with varying effectiveness** ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.22 Match each president to his diplomacy: Roosevelt, Taft, Wilson.

2

US.21 Why was the Panama Canal so important to the U.S.?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What do the letters MAIN stand for as causes of World War I?

✓ **ANSWER**

Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, and Nationalism.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

On June 28, 1914, a single gunshot in Sarajevo killed an archduke most Americans had never heard of, and within six weeks every great power in Europe was at war.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How can the murder of one man pull an entire continent, and eventually the world, into the deadliest war it had ever seen?

MAIN Causes of World War I

- Militarism: European nations competed to build larger armies and navies, with Germany's fleet expansion threatening British supremacy.
- Alliances: The Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) faced the Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain), creating a web of obligations that escalated local conflicts.
- Imperialism: Competition for colonies in Africa and Asia, and Balkan tensions as Austria-Hungary and Russia competed for influence.
- Nationalism: Ethnic tensions in multi-ethnic empires, Pan-Slavism, French desire to recover Alsace-Lorraine, and Serbian aspirations threatened stability.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

World War I was caused by the MAIN factors _____, and the spark that started it was _____.



Cartographer (public-domain map), 1914 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

The Spark and Escalation

- The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand (June 28, 1914) by Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip in Sarajevo triggered the July Crisis.
- Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia, activating the alliance system.
- Russian mobilization in support of Serbia led to German support for Austria, then French and British entry.
- Germany's invasion of Belgium, violating its neutrality, brought Britain into the war, transforming a Balkan crisis into a world war within weeks.

Reasons for U.S. Neutrality

- Traditional policy followed Washington's warning against foreign entanglements and the Monroe Doctrine's focus on the Western Hemisphere.
- Domestic considerations included German-American and Irish-American populations opposed to fighting Germany or helping Britain, profitable trade with both sides, and progressive views that European war represented old-world imperialism.
- Wilson hoped to serve as a neutral mediator, promoting "peace without victory." Practical challenges soon emerged: the British blockade interfered with trade to Central Powers while German submarine warfare threatened American ships and lives.

Key Figures

Archduke Franz Ferdinand

Heir to Austria-Hungary



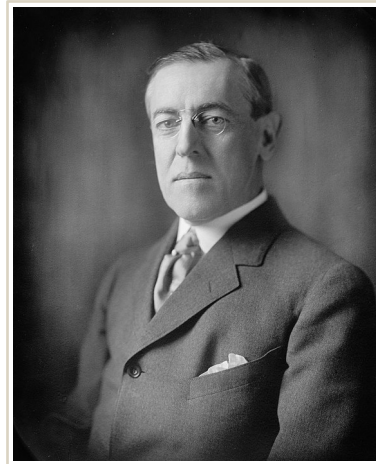
Unknown, c. 1914 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

- His assassination in Sarajevo (June 28, 1914) triggered the July Crisis
- Set off the chain of alliance obligations that became WWI

STRATEGY Use the assassination as the 'spark' to show how MAIN causes turned one murder into a world war.

Woodrow Wilson

28th President



Harris & Ewing, 1913 [Library of Congress](#)

- Declared U.S. neutrality in 1914
- Won reelection in 1916 on 'He kept us out of war'
- Would reverse course by 1917

STRATEGY Foreshadow US.24 by asking what could make a neutral nation change its mind.

U.S. Neutrality Proclamation

Close Reading

President Woodrow Wilson • August 19, 1914

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Harris & Ewing, 1913 [Library of Congress](#)

"The United States must be neutral in fact, as well as in name, during these days that are to try men's souls. We must be impartial in thought, as well as action, must put a curb upon our sentiments, as well as upon every transaction that might be construed as a preference of one party to the struggle before another."

CONTEXT

When war broke out in Europe in August 1914, President Wilson faced intense pressure from both sides. German Americans and Irish Americans (who resented British rule in Ireland) wanted America to remain neutral or even support Germany; British Americans and many pro-Allied voices wanted immediate support for Britain and France. Wilson's first instinct was neutrality — not only to keep America out of a destructive war but to position himself as a peace mediator. His August 1914 proclamation urged Americans to be 'impartial in thought as well as action.' In practice, American neutrality increasingly favored Britain, which controlled the seas and blocked trade with Germany while American loans and goods flowed to the Allies.

ANALYZE

What did Wilson urge Americans to do regarding the war in Europe?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Woodrow Wilson	August 19, 1914	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Militarism

Militarismo

say: MIL-ih-tuh-riz-um

M

The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.

Alliance System

Sistema de Alianzas

AS

The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).

Archduke Franz Ferdinand

Archiduque Francisco Fernando

say: ARCH-dook FRANTS FUR-dih-nand

AF

Heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne whose assassination in Sarajevo on June 28, 1914, by Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip triggered the chain of events leading to World War I.

Woodrow Wilson

Woodrow Wilson

WW

The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.

Imperialism

Imperialismo

say: im-PEER-ee-uh-liz-um

I

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Self-Determination

Autodeterminación

say: self dee-tur-mih-NAY-shun

S

The principle that nations and peoples should have the right to decide their own political status and form of government, a key idea in Wilson's Fourteen Points.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze causation (MAIN)

MODEL PROMPT: How did the MAIN causes turn an assassination into a world war?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Militarism and alliances meant a single spark pulled every great power in; imperialism and nationalism supplied the tension.

THINK ALOUD

Match each MAIN cause to a fact in the text.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain why the U.S. chose neutrality in 1914, using one reason from the reading.*

The Day the War Began - MAIN Causes Analysis

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using the alliance map and your notes, match each MAIN cause (Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, Nationalism) to a specific fact from Direct Instruction. Then trace, in three to four steps, how the assassination of Franz Ferdinand turned into a world war. Finish with one sentence explaining why the U.S. chose neutrality in 1914.



Unknown, c. 1914 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

DELIVERABLE

MAIN causes matched to evidence, a 3-4 step escalation chain, AND a one-sentence explanation of U.S. neutrality.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: MAIN acronym pre-defined with a fact bank to match; escalation steps provided out of order to sequence. Honors: Write a paragraph arguing which MAIN cause was most responsible for turning a regional crisis into a world war.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us23-main-causes-wwi.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What did Austria-Hungary's ultimatum demand of Serbia?

- A** Only an apology for the assassination
- B** Suppression of anti-Austrian publications, dissolution of nationalist groups, and removal of teachers promoting anti-Austrian views
- C** Financial compensation for the archduke's family
- D** Serbia become part of Austria-Hungary

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What did Austria-Hungary's ultimatum demand of Serbia?

- A** Only an apology for the assassination
- B** Suppression of anti-Austrian publications, dissolution of nationalist groups, and removal of teachers promoting anti-Austrian views ✓
- C** Financial compensation for the archduke's family
- D** Serbia become part of Austria-Hungary

Correct answer: B. Why: The ultimatum demanded Serbia "suppress every publication" against Austria, "dissolve" nationalist societies, and "eliminate" teachers who might spread anti-Austrian ideas.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- MAIN Causes of World War I
- The Spark and Escalation
- Reasons for U.S. Neutrality

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Which of the MAIN causes was most responsible for turning a regional crisis into a world war? Argue your case with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how the MAIN causes and the assassination of Franz Ferdinand worked together to start World War I.

STANDARD

US.24

Reasons for American Entry into World War I

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.01

Collect sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including: the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

I CAN

I can explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

Words you need before we read

Militarism

En español: *Militarismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.

Alliance System

En español: *Sistema de Alianzas*

WHAT IT MEANS

The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).

Archduke Franz Ferdinand

En español: *Archiduque Francisco Fernando*

WHAT IT MEANS

Heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne whose assassination in Sarajevo on June 28, 1914, by Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip triggered the chain of events leading to World War I.

Check your understanding

Analyze whether American neutrality was realistic given the country's economic and cultural ties to the belligerents.

- A** Despite official neutrality, American trade increasingly favored the Allies due to the British blockade, American loans went primarily to Allied nations, and cultural ties to Britain made true neutrality difficult ✓ KEY
- B** Neutrality was easily maintained throughout the war, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C** America had no ties to any European nation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- D** Economic factors were irrelevant to neutrality, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.23 What do the MAIN causes of World War I stand for?

2

US.23 Why did the U.S. declare neutrality in 1914?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was unrestricted submarine warfare?

✓ ANSWER

Germany's policy of sinking any ship near Britain, including neutral and passenger ships, without warning.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In early 1917 Britain handed the United States a decoded German telegram promising Mexico the return of Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona if it would attack America.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

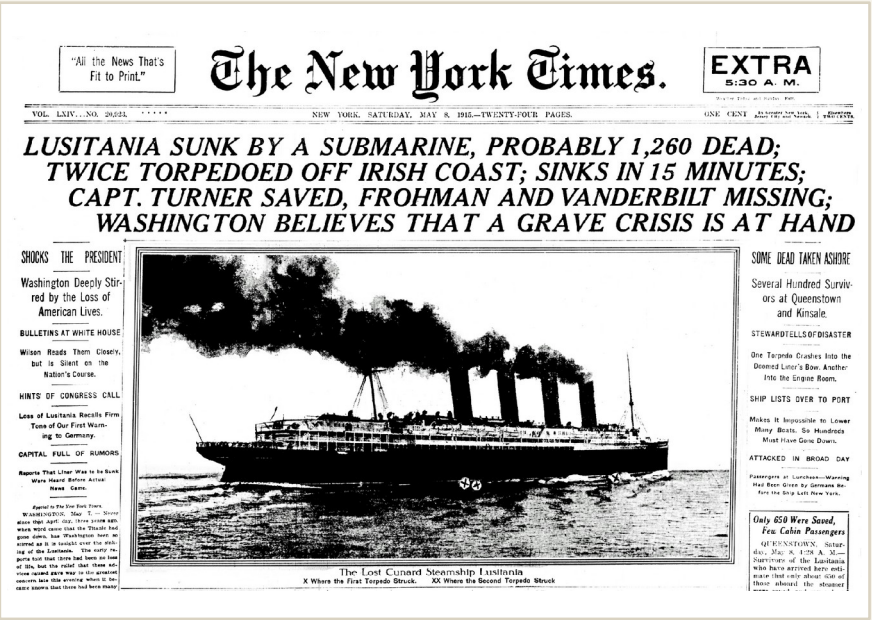
The U.S. had stayed neutral for nearly three years. What would it finally take to make a nation change its mind and go to war?

Unrestricted Submarine Warfare

- German U-boats would sink any ship entering the war zone around Britain without warning, violating international law and threatening neutral shipping.
- The Lusitania sinking (May 7, 1915) killed 1,198 including 128 Americans, shocking the public. Germany's Sussex Pledge (1916) promised warnings before attacks, but in February 1917, Germany resumed unrestricted submarine warfare, believing it could win before America mobilized.
- Wilson severed diplomatic relations and asked Congress to arm merchant ships.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The United States entered World War I because of _____ and _____, even though it had been _____.



The New York Times, 1915 [Wikimedia Commons \(The New York Times\)](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

The Zimmermann Telegram

- In January 1917, German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann proposed an alliance with Mexico if the U.S. entered the war, promising return of Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona.
- British intelligence decoded the telegram and shared it with America.
- Public reaction was outrage, especially in the Southwest, as it made German threat seem immediate and direct.
- The telegram convinced many Americans that Germany posed a direct threat to U.S. territory and helped build congressional support for war.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

When war came, Tennessee sent tens of thousands of soldiers; the state's draft boards and training at posts like Nashville's fairgrounds turned Volunteers into doughboys for the Western Front.

Defense of Democracy and Economic Motivations

- Wilson's rhetoric framed the war as a crusade to "make the world safe for democracy," portraying it as a struggle between democratic and autocratic systems.
- The Russian Revolution (March 1917), which overthrew the Tsar, made it easier to claim the Allies fought for democracy.
- Wilson's Fourteen Points emphasized democratic principles and self-determination.
- Economic factors also mattered: American banks had loaned over \$2 billion to the Allies, trade patterns favored the Allies, and war production created jobs and profits.
- German submarine attacks threatened these economic interests.

Key Figure

Woodrow Wilson

28th President



Harris & Ewing, 1913 [Library of Congress](#)

- Asked Congress for war on April 2, 1917
- Framed the war to 'make the world safe for democracy'
- Led U.S. mobilization

STRATEGY Read the war-message excerpt aloud, then have students identify Wilson's stated causes vs. underlying causes.

Zimmermann Telegram

Close Reading

German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann • January 1917

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.

Dec. 22, 1916
"We intend to begin on the first of February unrestricted submarine warfare. We shall endeavor in spite of this to keep the United States of America neutral. In the event of this not succeeding, we make Mexico a proposal of alliance on the following basis: make war together, make peace together, generous financial support and an understanding on our part that Mexico is to reconquer the lost territory in Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona. The settlement in detail is left to you. You will inform the President of the above most secretly as soon as the outbreak of war with the United States of America is certain and add the suggestion that he should, on his own initiative, ~~advise~~ ^{advise} Japan to immediate adherence and at the same time mediate between Japan and ourselves. Please call the President's attention to the fact that the ruthless employment of our submarines now offers the prospect of compelling England in a few months to make peace." Signed, ZIMMERMANN.

U.S. State Department / German Foreign Office, 1917 [U.S. National Archives](#)

"We intend to begin on the first of February unrestricted submarine warfare. We shall endeavor in spite of this to keep the United States of America neutral. In the event of this not succeeding, we make Mexico a proposal of alliance on the following basis: make war together, make peace together, generous financial support and an understanding on our part that Mexico is to reconquer the lost territory in Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona."

CONTEXT

The Zimmermann Telegram was one of the most dramatic intelligence coups in American history. In January 1917, German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann sent a coded telegram to the German ambassador in Mexico, proposing a military alliance: if the United States entered the war, Mexico should attack the U.S. in exchange for German support in recovering Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona. British intelligence intercepted and decoded the telegram and gave it to the U.S. government. When it was published on March 1, 1917, it outraged Americans and dramatically accelerated the shift toward war. The telegram came just weeks after Germany had resumed unrestricted submarine warfare.

ANALYZE

What did Germany propose to Mexico in the Zimmermann Telegram?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann	January 1917	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Unrestricted Submarine Warfare

Guerra Submarina Sin Restricciones

say: un-ree-STRIK-ted SUB-muh-reen WOR-fair

US

Germany's policy of attacking any ship—military or civilian—in the war zone around Britain without warning, which helped draw the United States into WWI.

RMS Lusitania

RMS Lusitania

say: loo-suh-TAY-nee-uh

RL

British passenger ship torpedoed by a German U-boat on May 7, 1915, killing 1,198 people including 128 Americans, turning American public opinion against Germany.

Militarism

Militarismo

say: MIL-ih-tuh-riz-um

M

The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.

Zimmermann Telegram

Telegrama Zimmermann

say: ZIM-er-mahn TEL-uh-gram

ZT

A 1917 secret message from Germany to Mexico proposing a military alliance against the United States, intercepted by the British and used to justify American entry into WWI.

Woodrow Wilson

Woodrow Wilson

WW

The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.

Alliance System

Sistema de Alianzas

AS

The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Distinguish stated vs.
underlying causes

MODEL PROMPT: Why did the U.S. abandon neutrality in 1917?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Unrestricted submarine warfare and the Zimmermann Telegram were the triggers; defense of democracy and economic ties were the deeper pull.

THINK ALOUD

Separate the immediate triggers from the long-term causes.

→ **Now you try:** *Rank the causes and justify your top choice with a line from Wilson.*

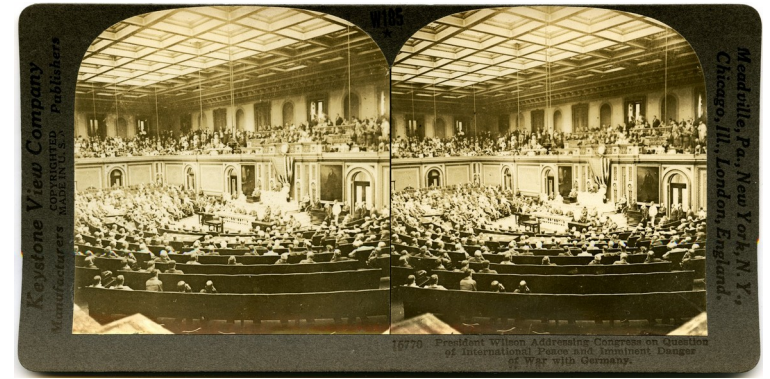
A Letter Home - Why the U.S. Entered WWI

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Wilson's war message and the Zimmermann Telegram. Separate the reasons the U.S. entered WWI into 'immediate triggers' and 'deeper causes.' List at least two in each category. Then, as a 1917 American, write a three-sentence 'letter home' explaining why you support (or oppose) going to war, citing one specific reason.



Unknown, 1917 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Two-column causes list (2+ per column) AND a three-sentence evidence-based 'letter home.'

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Cause cards to sort into 'trigger' vs. 'deeper cause,' with a sentence frame for the letter.
Honors: Write a paragraph arguing whether the U.S. entered mainly to defend democracy or to protect economic interests, using Wilson's own words.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us24-entry-into-wwi.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did Wilson justify American entry into World War I?

- A** To gain new territory and colonies
- B** To make the world safe for democracy and protect liberty
- C** To avenge the sinking of the Lusitania
- D** To support the British monarchy

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Wilson justify American entry into World War I?

- A To gain new territory and colonies
- B To make the world safe for democracy and protect liberty ✓**
- C To avenge the sinking of the Lusitania
- D To support the British monarchy

Correct answer: B. Why: Wilson declared "The world must be made safe for democracy" and emphasized "no selfish ends," "no conquest, no dominion"—framing it as a moral cause.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Unrestricted Submarine Warfare
- The Zimmermann Telegram
- Defense of Democracy and Economic Motivations

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did the U.S. enter WWI mainly to defend democracy or to protect economic interests? Use Wilson's war message and other evidence to argue your position. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain why the United States entered World War I in 1917, distinguishing the immediate triggers from the deeper causes.

STANDARD

US.25

Key Figures and Developments in World War I

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Identify and explain the impact of the following on World War I: Trench warfare, Use of new weapons and technology, Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, Alvin C. York. (TCA)

I CAN

I can identify and explain the impact of trench warfare, new weapons and technology, the Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, and Alvin C. York on World War I.

Words you need before we read

■ Unrestricted Submarine Warfare

En español: *Guerra Submarina Sin Restricciones*

WHAT IT MEANS

Germany's policy of attacking any ship—military or civilian—in the war zone around Britain without warning, which helped draw the United States into WWI.

■ Zimmermann Telegram

En español: *Telegrama Zimmermann*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1917 secret message from Germany to Mexico proposing a military alliance against the United States, intercepted by the British and used to justify American entry into WWI.

■ RMS Lusitania

En español: *RMS Lusitania*

WHAT IT MEANS

British passenger ship torpedoed by a German U-boat on May 7, 1915, killing 1,198 people including 128 Americans, turning American public opinion against Germany.

Check your understanding

Evaluate the relative importance of economic interests versus idealistic goals in America's decision for war.

A Only economic factors mattered, but this fails to account for the broader historical context when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic

B Both factors were important: economic ties to the Allies and threatened trade provided practical motivation, while democratic ideals gave moral justification—neither alone fully explains American entry

✓ KEY

C Only idealism drove the decision, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and fails to account for key developments in the broader context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic

D Neither economic nor idealistic factors played any role, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.24 Name the two events that most directly pushed the U.S. into World War I.

2

US.24 What was the Zimmermann Telegram?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was 'no man's land' in World War I?

✓ ANSWER

The deadly open ground between opposing trenches, full of barbed wire, craters, and machine-gun fire.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

A backwoods sharpshooter from Pall Mall, Tennessee, Alvin York, single-handedly silenced a German position and marched 132 prisoners back to American lines in a single morning.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

What makes an ordinary person from a small Tennessee town become one of the most decorated soldiers of a world war?

Trench Warfare and New Technologies

- Trenches stretched from the English Channel to Switzerland, creating a stalemate where neither side could achieve breakthrough.
- Conditions included mud, rats, disease, and constant threat of death.
- New weapons transformed warfare: machine guns made frontal assaults deadly, poison gas (chlorine, phosgene, mustard) caused horrific casualties, massive artillery bombardments destroyed landscapes, aircraft evolved from reconnaissance to fighters and bombers, and tanks helped break the stalemate.
- These innovations made WWI uniquely destructive.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Trench warfare meant soldiers fought from _____, and new technology such as _____ made the war _____.



Unknown (official war photograph), 1916 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Herbert Hoover and John J. Pershing

- Herbert Hoover headed the Commission for Relief in Belgium (1914-1917) and served as U.S. Food Administrator (1917-1919).
- He organized massive humanitarian relief and coordinated American food production through voluntary conservation ("Hooverize"), ensuring adequate supplies without rationing.
- General John J. Pershing commanded the American Expeditionary Forces, insisting on maintaining a separate American command rather than integrating with Allied forces.
- He emphasized open warfare tactics and maintained high morale, supporting major offensives that helped end the war.

Harlem Hellfighters and Alvin C. York

- The Harlem Hellfighters (369th Infantry Regiment) were African American soldiers from New York who served with French forces due to American military segregation.
- They spent 191 days in combat—longer than any other American unit—and earned many French military honors including the Croix de Guerre.
- Their service demonstrated African American military capability despite discrimination.
- Alvin C. York, a Tennessee farmer and former conscientious objector, became the most famous American soldier when he single-handedly captured 132 German soldiers in the Argonne Forest. He received the Medal of Honor and symbolized American frontier values and individual heroism.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Sergeant Alvin C. York of Pall Mall, Fentress County, became one of the most decorated American soldiers of World War I, capturing 132 German troops in the Meuse-Argonne and earning the Medal of Honor.



U.S. Army Signal Corps, 1919 [U.S. National Archives](#)

Key Figures

Alvin C. York

U.S. Army sergeant (Tennessee)



U.S. Army Signal Corps, 1919
[U.S. National Archives](#)

- From Pall Mall, Fentress County, Tennessee
- Captured 132 German soldiers in the Meuse-Argonne (Oct. 1918)
- Received the Medal of Honor

STRATEGY Lead with the Tennessee connection: York is a local hero students can claim.

Henry Johnson

Sergeant, 369th 'Harlem Hellfighters'



U.S. Army Signal Corps, c. 1919
[Wikimedia Commons \(U.S. Army\)](#)

- Fought off a German raiding party while badly wounded (May 1918)
- First American awarded the French Croix de Guerre
- Posthumously awarded the Medal of Honor in 2015

STRATEGY Use Johnson to make the Hellfighters concrete: contrast his valor abroad with the discrimination he faced at home.

Eddie Rickenbacker

Captain, American 'Ace of Aces'



U.S. Army Signal Corps, c. 1918
[U.S. National Archives](#)

- Credited with 26 aerial victories, the most of any U.S. pilot
- Symbolized the new air war of WWI
- Later awarded the Medal of Honor

STRATEGY Use Rickenbacker to introduce the new technology of aerial combat alongside the trenches.

Alvin C. York Medal of Honor Citation

Corroboration

U.S. War Department • 1918

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



U.S. Army Signal Corps, 1919 [U.S. National Archives](#)

"After his platoon had suffered heavy casualties and 3 other noncommissioned officers had become casualties, Corporal York assumed command. Fearlessly leading 7 men, he charged with great daring a machine gun nest which was pouring deadly and incessant fire upon his platoon. In this heroic feat the machine gun nest was taken, together with 4 officers and 128 men and several guns."

CONTEXT

Alvin York was a farmboy from the mountains of Tennessee who became the most decorated American soldier of World War I. Initially a conscientious objector because his religious faith opposed killing, York was eventually drafted and deployed to France. On October 8, 1918, in the Argonne Forest, Corporal York killed 28 German soldiers and captured 132 prisoners almost single-handedly. His Medal of Honor citation described actions that became legendary. York returned home a national hero and his story — a humble, religious backwoods rifleman succeeding in modern industrial war — became a powerful American myth celebrated in the 1941 Gary Cooper film.

ANALYZE

What made Sergeant York's actions remarkable according to this citation?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	U.S. War Department	1918	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Trench Warfare

Guerra de Trincheras

TW

A type of combat in which soldiers fight from elaborate systems of trenches, creating a stalemate where neither side could advance; characteristic of WWI's Western Front.

John J. Pershing

John J. Pershing

say: PUR-shing

JJ

Commander of the American Expeditionary Forces (AEF) in WWI, who insisted on keeping American troops together as an independent force rather than integrating them into Allied armies.

Alvin C. York

Alvin C. York

AC

A Tennessee soldier who became one of WWI's most decorated American heroes after single-handedly capturing 132 German soldiers in the Meuse-Argonne Offensive.

No Man's Land

Tierra de Nadie

NM

The dangerous, exposed ground between opposing trenches in WWI, filled with barbed wire, shell craters, and dead bodies.

Harlem Hellfighters

Harlem Hellfighters

say: HAR-lem HEL-fy-terz

HH

The 369th Infantry Regiment, a highly decorated African American unit that fought with the French army in WWI, spending 191 days in combat—more than any other American unit.

Meuse-Argonne Offensive

Ofensiva Meuse-Argonne

say: MYOOZ ar-GONN uh-FEN-siv

MO

The largest and deadliest American battle of WWI (September-November 1918), where 1.2 million U.S. soldiers fought, helping to end the war but costing 26,000 American lives.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Evaluate significance

MODEL PROMPT: Why did fresh American forces and figures like York and the Hellfighters matter?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

After years of stalemate in the trenches, U.S. troops and units like the 369th tipped the balance toward the Allies.

THINK ALOUD

Note one new technology and one heroic unit from the section.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain to a partner why Alvin York became a Tennessee legend.*

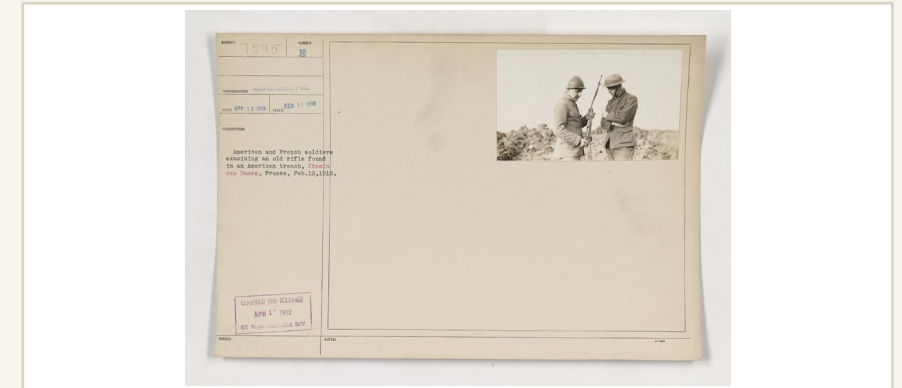
Letters from the Front - Technology and Heroes of WWI

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Create a two-part exhibit card. Part 1: describe how trench warfare and one new technology (machine gun, gas, tank, or aircraft) made WWI so deadly. Part 2: profile one American hero or unit (Alvin York, Henry Johnson, the Harlem Hellfighters, or Eddie Rickenbacker), including one accomplishment and why it mattered. End with one sentence on why fresh U.S. forces helped the Allies.



U.S. Army Signal Corps, 1918 [U.S. National Archives](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-part exhibit card (technology + hero profile) AND a one-sentence claim on the impact of U.S. forces.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Exhibit-card template with labeled sections and a word bank of technologies and heroes. Honors: Add a paragraph arguing whether the American Expeditionary Force changed the OUTCOME of the war or only its timing.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us25-wwi-technology-heroes.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What does this citation reveal about the Harlem Hellfighters' service?

- A** They served only in support roles behind the lines
- B** They achieved their combat objectives with distinction despite heavy losses
- C** They were rejected by both American and French forces
- D** Their service was not officially recognized

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What does this citation reveal about the Harlem Hellfighters' service?

- A They served only in support roles behind the lines
- B They achieved their combat objectives with distinction despite heavy losses ✓**
- C They were rejected by both American and French forces
- D Their service was not officially recognized

Correct answer: B. Why: The citation praises the 369th for capturing objectives "in magnificent style" while "advancing without regard to losses," earning French recognition.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Trench Warfare and New Technologies
- Herbert Hoover and John J. Pershing
- Harlem Hellfighters and Alvin C. York

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did the American Expeditionary Force change the OUTCOME of the war or only its timing? Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how new technology and the arrival of American forces changed the fighting of World War I. Use one technology and one figure or unit as evidence.

STANDARD

US.26

World War I Home Front

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including: Role played by women and minorities, Voluntary rationing, Committee on Public Information, Opposition by conscientious objectors, Schenck v. United States decision.

I CAN

I can analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including the role of women and minorities, voluntary rationing, the Committee on Public Information, conscientious objectors, and the Schenck v. United States decision.

Words you need before we read

Trench Warfare

En español: *Guerra de Trincheras*

WHAT IT MEANS

A type of combat in which soldiers fight from elaborate systems of trenches, creating a stalemate where neither side could advance; characteristic of WWI's Western Front.

No Man's Land

En español: *Tierra de Nadie*

WHAT IT MEANS

The dangerous, exposed ground between opposing trenches in WWI, filled with barbed wire, shell craters, and dead bodies.

John J. Pershing

En español: *John J. Pershing*

WHAT IT MEANS

Commander of the American Expeditionary Forces (AEF) in WWI, who insisted on keeping American troops together as an independent force rather than integrating them into Allied armies.

Check your understanding

Analyze how technological innovations and individual heroism both shaped the American experience in WWI.

- A Technology was irrelevant to the American experience, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B Individual heroism was unimportant in modern war, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- C New weapons created the brutal conditions Americans faced while individual heroes like York and the Hellfighters showed how Americans adapted and excelled despite the horrors of modern warfare** ✓ KEY
- D Americans were not affected by new technologies, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.25 Why did trench warfare create a stalemate on the Western Front?

2

US.25 Who was Alvin York and why is he important to Tennessee?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the Committee on Public Information?

✓ ANSWER

The WWI government agency, led by George Creel, that used posters, films, and speakers to build support for the war.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

During World War I the U.S. government created an agency whose only job was to shape what Americans thought, printing millions of posters and sending 75,000 speakers into movie theaters.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a country goes to war, how much power should the government have to control what its own citizens say and believe?

Political Changes and Expanded Federal Power

- The federal government assumed unprecedented control through agencies like the War Industries Board (coordinating production), Selective Service Act (drafting 24 million men), and the Espionage Act (1917) and Sedition Act (1918), which restricted free speech.
- Executive authority expanded dramatically, and the government prosecuted anti-war activists, socialists, and German-Americans who were seen as disloyal.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

On the home front, the government expanded its power by _____, but it also limited liberty by _____.

Economic Effects and Voluntary Rationing

- Herbert Hoover's Food Administration promoted voluntary conservation through "Meatless Mondays" and "Wheatless Wednesdays" rather than mandatory rationing.
- Victory Gardens produced 20% of vegetables.
- Liberty Bonds raised \$21 billion to finance the war.
- Price controls regulated essential commodities while factories converted to military production, creating economic growth and full employment, though inflation also rose.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee families joined nationwide 'meatless' and 'wheatless' days, and the state's farms and Nashville's mills geared up to feed and supply the war effort.



Charles Edward Chambers, U.S. Food Administration, 1917 [Library of Congress](#)

Women and Minorities

- Women entered factories, munitions plants, and previously male-dominated jobs, serving as nurses and support personnel in the military.
- Their war service strengthened arguments for suffrage.
- The Great Migration brought 500,000 African Americans north for industrial jobs, though they faced continued discrimination. 400,000 African Americans served in segregated military units.
- Mexican Americans and Native Americans also contributed, though all minorities faced ongoing prejudice despite their service.

Propaganda, Conscientious Objectors, and Civil Liberties

- George Creel's Committee on Public Information used posters, films, pamphlets, and "Four Minute Men" speakers to build support and promote anti-German sentiment.
- About 65,000 conscientious objectors claimed exemption based on religious or moral beliefs, facing imprisonment or alternative service.
- The Supreme Court's *Schenck v. United States* (1919) decision upheld restrictions on free speech, establishing the "clear and present danger" test. Justice Holmes wrote that free speech would not protect "falsely shouting fire in a theatre."



James Montgomery Flagg, 1917 [Library of Congress](#)

Key Figures

George Creel

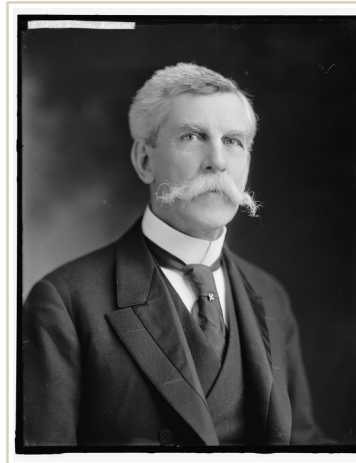
Head of the Committee on Public Information

- Directed the CPI wartime propaganda agency
- Mobilized posters, films, and '4-Minute Men' speakers
- Shaped public opinion to support the war

STRATEGY Have students analyze a real CPI poster for persuasive techniques before naming propaganda.

Oliver Wendell Holmes Jr.

Supreme Court Justice



Harris & Ewing, c. 1902 [Library of Congress](#)

- Wrote the Schenck v. United States opinion (1919)
- Created the 'clear and present danger' test
- Upheld limits on wartime speech

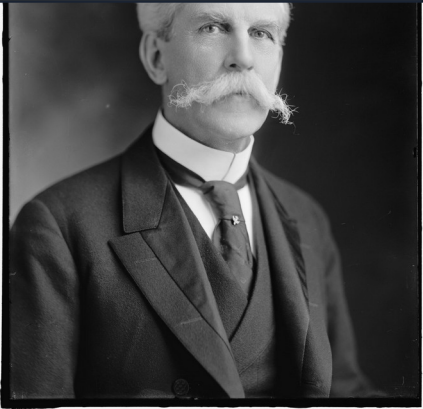
STRATEGY Frame Schenck as the trade-off between security and liberty for a wrap-up debate.

Schenck v. United States Decision

Close Reading

Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes • 1919

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Harris & Ewing, c. 1902 [Library of Congress](#)

"The question in every case is whether the words used are used in such circumstances and are of such a nature as to create a clear and present danger that they will bring about the substantive evils that Congress has a right to prevent. When a nation is at war, many things that might be said in time of peace are such a hindrance to its effort that their utterance will not be endured."

CONTEXT

Charles Schenck was the general secretary of the Socialist Party who was convicted under the Espionage Act for distributing leaflets opposing the military draft during World War I. In the Supreme Court's first major First Amendment ruling, Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes wrote a unanimous 1919 decision upholding Schenck's conviction. Holmes established the famous 'clear and present danger' test — speech could be restricted if it created a 'clear and present danger' of causing harm. His analogy of falsely shouting 'fire' in a crowded theater has been quoted ever since. Holmes later changed his view and dissented in *Abrams v. United States* (1919), arguing for stronger free speech protections.

ANALYZE

What standard did the Supreme Court establish for limiting free speech during wartime?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes	1919	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Committee on Public Information

Comité de Información Pública

say: kuh-MIT-ee on PUB-lik in-fer-MAY-shun

CO

A government propaganda agency created in 1917 to build support for WWI through posters, films, speeches, and censorship of anti-war messages.

Schenck v. United States

Schenck v. Estados Unidos

say: SHENK versus united states

SV

A 1919 Supreme Court case that upheld the Espionage Act, ruling that speech creating a "clear and present danger" could be restricted, even in peacetime.

Armistice Day

Día del Armisticio

AD

November 11, 1918—the day WWI fighting ended at 11:00 AM when Germany signed an armistice agreement; now commemorated as Veterans Day in the United States.

Espionage and Sedition Acts

Leyes de Espionaje y Sedición

say: ES-pee-uh-nahzh and suh-DISH-un akts

EA

Laws passed in 1917-1918 making it illegal to interfere with the draft, criticize the government or war effort, or encourage disloyalty, severely limiting free speech during WWI.

George Creel

George Creel

say: KREEL

GC

Journalist who headed the Committee on Public Information during WWI, creating America's first large-scale government propaganda campaign to build support for the war.

Woodrow Wilson

Woodrow Wilson

WW

The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Weigh liberty vs. security

MODEL PROMPT: How did the home front expand government power and limit civil liberties?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The CPI shaped opinion, the Espionage and Sedition Acts criminalized dissent, and Schenck let the Court uphold those limits.

THINK ALOUD

List one gain (mobilization) and one cost (lost liberty).

→ **Now you try:** *Take a side on Schenck and back it with the 'clear and present danger' test.*

Ration Books and Rosie - Home Front Power vs. Liberty

Pairs

12 min

YOUR TASK

Using a CPI poster and your notes, build a T-chart: on one side, list ways WWI expanded federal power and mobilized the home front (CPI, rationing, women and minorities in new roles); on the other, list ways it limited civil liberties (Espionage and Sedition Acts, Schenck). Then write a one-sentence claim on whether the wartime limits on speech were justified.

DELIVERABLE

Completed T-chart with 2+ items per side AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about wartime speech limits.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: T-chart with a word bank to sort into 'expanded power' vs. 'limited liberty.' Honors: Write a paragraph using Schenck's 'clear and present danger' test to argue whether the limits were an emergency necessity or a government overreach.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us26-home-front.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-3/us26-home-front.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What standard did the Supreme Court establish for limiting free speech during wartime?

A Speech creating a "clear and present danger" could be restricted

B All criticism of the government was forbidden

C Only written criticism could be punished

D Free speech was absolute even in wartime

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What standard did the Supreme Court establish for limiting free speech during wartime?

- A** Speech creating a "clear and present danger" could be restricted ✓
- B** All criticism of the government was forbidden
- C** Only written criticism could be punished
- D** Free speech was absolute even in wartime

Correct answer: A. Why: Holmes established the "clear and present danger" test, stating speech could be limited if it creates danger "that Congress has a right to prevent."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Political Changes and Expanded Federal Power
- Economic Effects and Voluntary Rationing
- Women and Minorities
- Propaganda, Conscientious Objectors, and Civil Liberties

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: Were the wartime limits on free speech justified by the emergency, or an overreach of government power?
Argue your position using Schenck and at least one other example. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how World War I expanded the power of the federal government AND limited civil liberties on the home front. Give one example of each.

STANDARD

US.27

Wilson's Fourteen Points and League of Nations

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

I CAN

I can analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

Words you need before we read

Committee on Public Information

En español: *Comité de Información Pública*

WHAT IT MEANS

A government propaganda agency created in 1917 to build support for WWI through posters, films, speeches, and censorship of anti-war messages.

Espionage and Sedition Acts

En español: *Leyes de Espionaje y Sedición*

WHAT IT MEANS

Laws passed in 1917-1918 making it illegal to interfere with the draft, criticize the government or war effort, or encourage disloyalty, severely limiting free speech during WWI.

Schenck v. United States

En español: *Schenck v. Estados Unidos*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1919 Supreme Court case that upheld the Espionage Act, ruling that speech creating a "clear and present danger" could be restricted, even in peacetime.

Check your understanding

Analyze how the *Schenck v. United States* decision balanced national security needs with First Amendment rights.

- A** The Court fully protected free speech, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B** The Court declared all wartime speech restrictions unconstitutional, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C** The case had no impact on free speech law, but the historical record tells a more complex story, which represents a common misconception about this historical period and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D** **The Court ruled speech creating "clear and present danger" could be restricted, upholding Schenck's conviction and establishing that First Amendment rights are not absolute during wartime emergencies** ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.26 What did the Espionage and Sedition Acts do?

2

US.26 What did the Supreme Court decide in Schenck v. United States?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What were Wilson's Fourteen Points?

✓ ANSWER

Wilson's 1918 peace plan calling for open diplomacy, self-determination, and a League of Nations.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

President Wilson sailed to Paris in 1919 with a plan to end all future wars, and returned home to watch the U.S. Senate reject it and refuse to join the League he had built.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

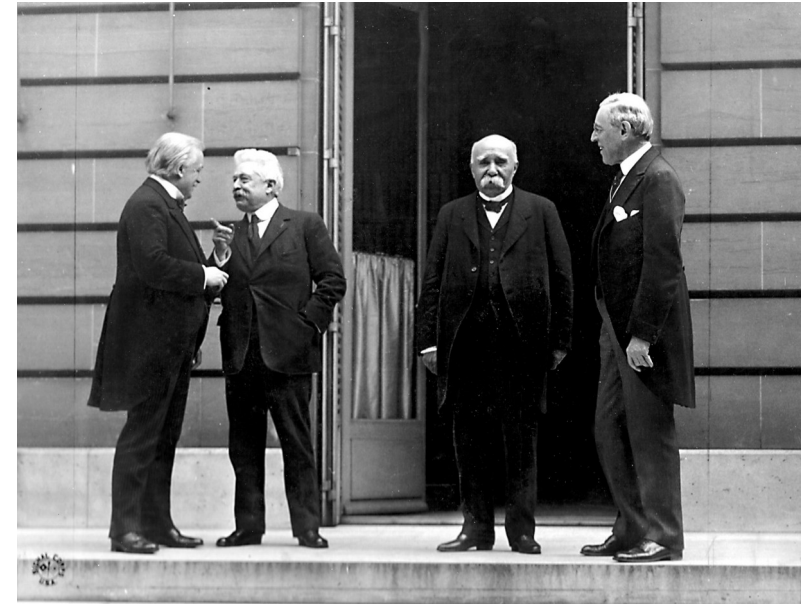
If a president negotiates a peace treaty for the whole world, why should the Senate be able to say no?

Wilson's Fourteen Points

- Announced January 8, 1918, Wilson's Fourteen Points outlined his vision for post-war peace.
- Key principles included: open diplomacy (ending secret treaties), freedom of the seas, free trade, arms reduction, impartial adjustment of colonial claims, and specific territorial settlements based on self-determination.
- The fourteenth point called for a League of Nations to guarantee political independence and territorial integrity for all nations.
- Wilson aimed for "peace without victory" that would not create resentment leading to future wars.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Wilson's Fourteen Points called for _____, but the U.S. Senate rejected the League because _____.



Edward N. Jackson (U.S. Army Signal Corps), 1919 [U.S. National Archives](https://www.archives.gov)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Causes of U.S. Rejection of the League

- The Senate rejected League membership for several reasons.
- Senator Henry Cabot Lodge and "Reservationists" wanted amendments protecting U.S. sovereignty, particularly regarding Article X, which required members to defend each other against aggression.
- "Irreconcilables" opposed any membership.
- Critics worried the League would entangle America in foreign conflicts and override congressional war powers.
- Wilson's refusal to compromise, his stroke during his speaking tour, and partisan politics all contributed.
- The Senate rejected the Treaty of Versailles and League membership in 1919 and 1920.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee's senators took part in the Senate fight over the Treaty of Versailles, reflecting the national divide over whether the U.S. should join the League of Nations.



Leonard Raven-Hill, 1919 [Wikimedia Commons \(Punch\)](#)

Impact on World Politics

- American absence fundamentally weakened the League of Nations.
- Without U.S. participation, the League lacked the power to enforce its decisions.
- Britain and France dominated a weakened organization that proved unable to prevent aggression in the 1930s.
- The League failed to stop Japan in Manchuria (1931), Italy in Ethiopia (1935), or Germany's expansion.
- Wilson's idealistic vision remained unfulfilled, and American isolationism contributed to conditions that led to World War II.
- The failure informed later creation of the United Nations with stronger American involvement.

Key Figures

Woodrow Wilson

28th President



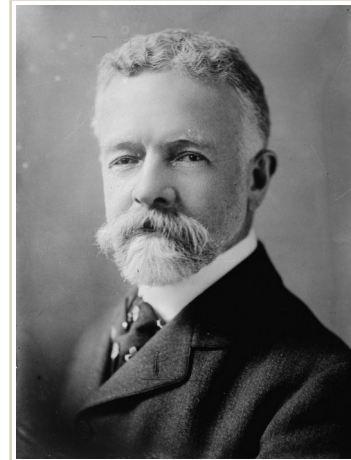
Harris & Ewing, 1913 [Library of Congress](#)

- Proposed the Fourteen Points (Jan. 1918)
- Championed self-determination and a League of Nations
- Won the 1919 Nobel Peace Prize

STRATEGY Group the Fourteen Points into categories (open diplomacy, self-determination, the League) so students see the structure.

Henry Cabot Lodge

U.S. Senator (Massachusetts)



Unknown, c. 1919 [Library of Congress](#)

- Led Senate opposition to the Treaty of Versailles
- Feared the League would drag the U.S. into foreign wars
- Blocked U.S. membership in the League

STRATEGY Use Lodge to show the constitutional fight: the president negotiates, but the Senate ratifies.

The Fourteen Points

Argumentation

President Woodrow Wilson • January 8, 1918

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



William Orpen, 1919 [Imperial War Museum \(William Orpen\)](#)

"A general association of nations must be formed under specific covenants for the purpose of affording mutual guarantees of political independence and territorial integrity to great and small states alike... Open covenants of peace, openly arrived at, after which there shall be no private international understandings of any kind."

CONTEXT

On January 8, 1918 — while the war was still being fought — President Wilson addressed Congress to outline America's war aims and peace objectives in his 'Fourteen Points' speech. The speech was both a war aim statement and a peace proposal, designed to appeal to war-weary peoples in Germany and Austria-Hungary and to provide a moral framework for the eventual peace settlement. Key points included freedom of the seas, national self-determination, open diplomacy, disarmament, and — most importantly to Wilson — a League of Nations to resolve future disputes peacefully. The Fourteen Points became the basis on which Germany agreed to an armistice in November 1918, believing the peace would be based on Wilson's principles.

ANALYZE

What did Wilson propose to prevent future wars?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Woodrow Wilson	January 8, 1918	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Fourteen Points

Catorce Puntos

say: FOR-teen points

FP

Woodrow Wilson's 1918 peace plan emphasizing self-determination, free trade, open diplomacy, disarmament, and the creation of a League of Nations.

League of Nations

Liga de Naciones

say: leeg of NAY-shunz

LO

An international organization created after WWI to prevent future wars through collective security and diplomacy; the United States never joined due to Senate opposition.

Self-Determination

Autodeterminación

say: self dee-tur-mih-NAY-shun

S

The principle that nations and peoples should have the right to decide their own political status and form of government, a key idea in Wilson's Fourteen Points.

Treaty of Versailles

Tratado de Versailles

say: TREE-tee of ver-SIGH

TO

The 1919 peace treaty ending WWI that blamed Germany for the war, imposed massive reparations, stripped Germany of territory, and created the League of Nations.

Henry Cabot Lodge

Henry Cabot Lodge

say: KAB-ut lodj

HC

Republican Senator from Massachusetts who led opposition to the Treaty of Versailles and League of Nations, fearing it would limit U.S. sovereignty and entangle America in European conflicts.

Woodrow Wilson

Woodrow Wilson

WW

The 28th U.S. President (1913-1921) who led America through WWI, promoted Moral Diplomacy, authored the Fourteen Points, and championed the League of Nations.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze cause of failure

MODEL PROMPT: Why did the U.S. reject the treaty its own president negotiated?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Wilson wanted the League; Lodge and the Senate feared it would surrender the power to declare war, so they refused to ratify.

THINK ALOUD

Identify Wilson's goal and Lodge's objection.

→ **Now you try:** *Predict one consequence of the U.S. staying out of the League.*

Fourteen Points and After - Why the League Failed in the U.S.

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using the Fourteen Points and your notes, group Wilson's plan into three categories (open diplomacy, self-determination, the League of Nations). Then list the two strongest reasons the U.S. Senate rejected the treaty. Finish with a two-sentence prediction of one consequence of the U.S. staying out of the League.

DELIVERABLE

Fourteen Points grouped into three categories, two Senate objections listed, AND a two-sentence consequence prediction.



William Orpen, 1919 [Imperial War Museum \(William Orpen\)](#)

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Point cards to sort into the three categories and a word bank of Senate objections.
Honors: Write a paragraph arguing who bears more responsibility for the U.S. rejecting the League, Wilson or the Senate, using two pieces of evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-3/us27-fourteen-points-league.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What did Wilson propose to prevent future wars?

- A** A strong American military to police the world
- B** A general association of nations with open agreements
- C** Isolation of America from all foreign affairs
- D** Division of Europe among the Allied Powers

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What did Wilson propose to prevent future wars?

- A A strong American military to police the world
- B A general association of nations with open agreements ✓**
- C Isolation of America from all foreign affairs
- D Division of Europe among the Allied Powers

Correct answer: B. Why: Wilson called for "A general association of nations... for the purpose of affording mutual guarantees" and "Open covenants of peace, openly arrived at."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Wilson's Fourteen Points
- Causes of U.S. Rejection of the League
- Impact on World Politics

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Who bears more responsibility for the U.S. rejecting the League, Wilson or the Senate? Defend your claim with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain why the United States rejected the Treaty of Versailles and the League of Nations, even though its own president had negotiated them.

Unit 3 Complete

American Imperialism & World War I (1890–1920) · from empire and the Great Debate to the trenches of France and the fight over the peace.

Revisit your unit hook: How did a nation founded against empire become a world power? You can now answer with evidence — from Mahan and the Spanish-American War to the Zimmermann Telegram and the Treaty of Versailles.

Next: Unit 4 — The 1920s & the Great Depression

Words you need before we read

■ Fourteen Points

En español: *Catorce Puntos*

WHAT IT MEANS

Woodrow Wilson's 1918 peace plan emphasizing self-determination, free trade, open diplomacy, disarmament, and the creation of a League of Nations.

■ Treaty of Versailles

En español: *Tratado de Versalles*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1919 peace treaty ending WWI that blamed Germany for the war, imposed massive reparations, stripped Germany of territory, and created the League of Nations.

■ League of Nations

En español: *Liga de Naciones*

WHAT IT MEANS

An international organization created after WWI to prevent future wars through collective security and diplomacy; the United States never joined due to Senate opposition.

Check your understanding

Evaluate whether Wilson's idealistic approach to international relations was realistic for the post-war world.

- A** Wilson's vision of collective security and self-determination was inspiring but faced practical obstacles including Senate opposition, European power politics, and the difficulty of enforcing peace without American commitment ✓ KEY
- B** Wilson's approach was completely realistic, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C** Idealism played no role in Wilson's thinking, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** The League succeeded despite American absence, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.